CAT DILR Practice Log & Skill Progression Tracker

From Untimed Deconstruction to 10-Minute Sprints: 150-Set Taxonomy & Error Diagnostics

1. The 3-Phase DILR Competency Progression Framework

Build durable logical reasoning schemas across 150 diverse sets over 6 months.

Preparation Phase	Target Set Volume	Timing Protocol	Core Skill Developed
Phase 1: Representation Mastery (Sets 1-50)	50 Sets (5 per week)	UNTIMED (Allow 30-45 mins if needed)	Master clean grid structuring, matrix representations & branching
Phase 2: Semi-Timed Consolidation (Sets 51-100)	50 Sets (7 per week)	18 Minutes per Set	Identify bottleneck clues; practice case-elimination logic
Phase 3: Exam-Pace Sprints (Sets 101-150)	50 Sets (10 per week)	10 to 12 Minutes per Set	Rapid scanning, trap detection & selective question answering

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Target: A student who analyzes 150 sets systematically will encounter virtually no unfamiliar logic types on CAT day.

2. High-Frequency CAT DILR Archetype Checklist

Ensure your practice log covers all 8 classic and contemporary DILR puzzle categories.

Set Archetype	Core Characteristics	Essential Diagramming Tool	Solved / Mastered Checkbox
Linear & Circular Arrangements	Ordering with constraints and directions	Dual-row sketch or circle with facing arrows	[ ] 20 Sets Minimum
Matrix & Grid Matching	Matching 3-4 attributes to entities	Multi-attribute grid with tick/cross notation	[ ] 25 Sets Minimum
Games & Tournaments	Round-robin, knockouts, points tables	Points table with total matches / goals balance	[ ] 20 Sets Minimum
Venn Diagrams & Set Theory	3-set and 4-set overlaps with max/min	Euler circles with algebraic equations in regions	[ ] 15 Sets Minimum
Routes, Networks & Optimization	Flow charts, pipeline capacities, shortest paths	Directed graph with flow values at nodes	[ ] 15 Sets Minimum
Data Caselets & Missing Tables	Incomplete tables requiring algebraic deduction	Cross-sum verification table	[ ] 25 Sets Minimum
Scatter Plots & Dual-Axis Charts	Graphical data interpretation with percentages	Quadrant analysis & slope visualization	[ ] 15 Sets Minimum
Novel Reasoning / Binary Logic	Truth-tellers, liars, custom board games	Truth table with assumption-contradiction branches	[ ] 15 Sets Minimum

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Log Rule: Never count a set as "completed" until you re-solve it cleanly 4 days later.

3. The 4-Column Error Logging System

Record every failed set attempt to pinpoint cognitive breakdown points.

- Column 1: Set Source & Category (e.g. CAT 2023 Slot 2 - Games & Tournaments).
- Column 2: Root Failure Mechanism (Misread constraint, chose wrong diagram, arithmetic slip, or missed hidden case).
- Column 3: The Critical Pivot Clue (The exact sentence that would have unlocked the entire puzzle).
- Column 4: Retest Date (Date scheduled for re-attempt without looking at historical notes).